

Meet the CHAMPIONS

Here's a closer look at the **history-making** Indian squad, with every player stepping up at key moments to fulfil a dream 52 years in the making.

Harmanpreet Kaur

Age: 36

From: Moga, Punjab

As a teenager, Harmanpreet began playing cricket with boys in her locality, showing a keen interest in the sport from an early age. In 2009, she made her ODI debut against Pakistan during the World Cup.

WC25: In her first ODI World Cup as captain, Harmanpreet has led from the front, rallying her side superbly. She stood out against England in a crucial league-stage fixture with a run-a-ball 70, albeit in a losing cause. Two matches later she came good again, scoring a vital 88-ball 89 in the semifinal against Australia, forging a key partnership with Jemimah Rodrigues. In the final, she took a bold punt on Shafali Verma with the ball — a move that paid off with two wickets. Fittingly, it was Harmanpreet who took the winning catch to seal India's historic title.

260 runs in 8 innings (HS: 89; Avg: 32.50; SR: 89.04)

« This is the start. We wanted to break this barrier. And our next plan is to make this a habit. So many big occasions are coming, and we want to keep improving. This is not the end, just the beginning.